TIMEOUT

CLEAN IT UP

How you can salvage your online persona

COMPLETE TOURNAMENT COVERAGE AND BRACKET IN SPORTS

NCAA: BEARS IN; GAELS OUT

Cal Bears land a No. 7 seed, faces Maryland in first round

Saint Mary's snubbed after 26-6 season

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DAWNING GREEN

D. ROSS CAMERON/STAFF

MICAH FROMKIN, left, crew leader for Solar City solar panel installers, and Christian Lee, a junior installer, hoist a solar panel onto the roof of a residential building in San Francisco on Wednesday.

Programs train 'foot soldiers for Mother Earth'

By Julia Scott
STAFF WRITER

SAN FRANCISCO — Micah Fromkin loves his job.

A newly-minted solar panel installer with SolarCity, the 30-year-old is earning more money than he ever has and has already been promoted — twice.

But nothing beats the feeling that he and his fellow crewmen get from doing their job, one of the most coveted jobs in the Bay Area's growing "clean tech" sector.

"We jokingly refer to ourselves as the foot solders for Mother Earth," said Fromkin, who spent Wednesday afternoon installing solar panels on the roof of a San Francisco home.

Fromkin and five other SolarCity crewmen are recent graduates of a solar Installer program at Skyline College in San Bruno, a program so popular that a new class starting this Friday is full with a waiting list of 30, according to Mike Williamson, dean of science, math and technology at Skyline.

It was with that level of interest in mind that Williamson successfully ap-

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Car mileage proposal puts privacy at issue

■ Assemblywoman's bill would require tracking of vehicles' odometer readings

By Denis Cuff
STAFF WRITER

A proposal to chart global warming gases from California cars and trucks by requiring motorists to report odometer readings during annual vehicle registrations is meeting resistance from those worried about drivers' privacy.

Assemblywoman Nancy Skinner, D-Berkeley, has proposed the odometer reporting law, saying California needs to estimate miles traveled to succeed in its pioneering drive to control global warming gases — much of which comes from vehicles.

But even some who want to reduce carbon dioxide and other greenhouse gases said the state needs to ensure that the information will not be released publicly or used to compel individuals to drive less.

Skinner

"This is the issue of Big Brother watching us," said Amy Worth, an Orinda city councilwoman on the Metropolitan Transportation Commission, or MTC, a regional planning and funding agency. "I want more information on how the privacy issues will be addressed before I support this."

Worth and Solano County Supervisor James Spering dissented Friday when an MTC committee voted 4-2 to support, in concept, Assembly Bill 1135, the odometer reporting bill.

"I don't have any trust in the Legislature protecting my information," Spering said.

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Democrats to revamp Bay Area federal courts

■ Obama, Boxer and Feinstein prepare to move forward with selection of judges, other officials

By Howard Mintz
MEDIANEWS STAFF

The wheels are in motion for the Obama administration to start shaping the Bay Area's federal courts and a California-based federal appeals court that is the largest in the nation, giving Democrats their first opportunity in eight years to name federal judges who decide everything from Silicon Valley's titanic high-tech feuds to the fate of the state's death-row inmates.

By summer, President Barack Obama is likely to have put his initial stamp on the local judiciary, with seats open in San Jose and San Francisco. In addition, the White House will be selecting Northern California's new U.S. attorney, the region's top law-enforcement official, as well as a new U.S. marshal for the area.

Democratic Sens. Dianne Feinstein and Barbara Boxer will be largely responsible for picking judges, U.S. attorneys and marshals in California's four judicial districts, following the tradition of home state senators of the president's political party handling those appointments. Both senators have committees screening candidates.

Meanwhile, the White House is expected to handle nominations to the 9th U.S. Circuit Court of Appeals, which has two vacancies and a third that will come open at the end of this year on the 29-member court, which covers California and eight other states in the West.

See JUDGES, Page 11

MORNING REPORT

TO OUR READERS

Beginning Tuesday, readers will notice a number of changes to The Tribune, chief among them the addition of a late-breaking news section we're calling the Morning Report.

By tweaking our production times and press runs, we'll be able to publish more developing stories from around the country and region. This stand-alone section will contain all the national and world news previously found in the Nation-World roundup, plus breaking local news. Our daily weather page and the Lotto results will also be in the new section.

In addition, we'll be expanding our coverage of high school sports to include schools from around the Bay Area. The enhanced prep coverage will include more box scores, summaries and game stories so fans of high school athletics can more closely follow schools from the entire region.

The changes in our print schedules will allow Bay Area News Group – East Bay to save money on production and delivery. With the addition of the Morning Report and the expanded sports section, we'll be able to capture those savings in a way that improves our coverage overall.

— **Kevin G. Keane,** VP of News/Executive Editor BANG-EB

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